

Information Technology Act, 2000 - Key Sections & Punishments

Detailed Cyber Law Sections

Section 65: Tampering with Computer Source Documents

Meaning: Whoever knowingly or intentionally conceals, destroys or alters or intentionally or knowingly causes another to conceal, destroy, or alter any computer source code used for a computer, computer programme, computer system or computer network.

Punishment: Imprisonment up to 3 years, or fine up to Rs 2 lakh, or both.

Section 66: Computer Related Offences

Meaning: If any person, dishonestly or fraudulently, does any act referred to in section 43 (damage to computer, computer system, etc), he shall be punishable.

Punishment: Imprisonment up to 3 years or fine up to Rs 5 lakh or both.

Section 66B: Stolen Computer Resource

Meaning: Dishonestly receiving or retaining stolen computer resources or communication devices.

Punishment: Imprisonment up to 3 years or fine up to Rs 1 lakh or both.

Section 66C: Identity Theft

Meaning: Fraudulently using electronic signatures, passwords, or unique identification features of others.

Punishment: Imprisonment up to 3 years and fine up to Rs 1 lakh.

Section 66D: Cheating by Personation

Meaning: Cheating by personating someone using a communication device or computer resource.

Punishment: Imprisonment up to 3 years and fine up to Rs 1 lakh.

Section 66E: Violation of Privacy

Meaning: Capturing or transmitting private images of a person without consent.

Punishment: Imprisonment up to 3 years or fine up to Rs 2 lakh or both.

Section 66F: Cyber Terrorism

Meaning: Acts intended to threaten the unity, integrity, security, or sovereignty of India or strike terror in people using computer resources.

Punishment: Imprisonment which may extend to imprisonment for life.

Section 67: Obscene Material

Meaning: Publishing or transmitting material which is lascivious or appeals to the prurient interest in electronic form.

Punishment: First: Up to 3 years and fine up to Rs 5 lakh. Subsequent: Up to 5 years and fine up to Rs 10 lakh.

Section 67A: Sexually Explicit Content

Meaning: Publishing or transmitting material containing sexually explicit acts in electronic form.

Punishment: First: Up to 5 years and fine up to Rs 10 lakh. Subsequent: Up to 7 years and fine up to Rs 10 lakh.

Section 67B: Child Pornography

Meaning: Publishing or transmitting material depicting children in sexually explicit acts in electronic form.

Punishment: First: Up to 5 years and fine up to Rs 10 lakh. Subsequent: Up to 7 years and fine up to Rs 10 lakh.

Awareness and Reporting Actions

National Portal: Report any cybercrime at www.cybercrime.gov.in immediately.

Helpline: Call the National Cyber Crime Helpline number **1930** for immediate assistance, especially for financial frauds.

Financial Fraud: If money is stolen, report within the first 'Golden Hour' (2 hours) to increase chances of recovery.

Evidence: Keep screenshots, URLs, email headers, and transaction IDs as evidence for investigation.

Recovery from Cyber Hacking

Step 1: Secure Accounts. Immediately change passwords for all compromised accounts using a different, clean device.

Step 2: Enable 2FA. Turn on Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) wherever possible to prevent future unauthorized access.

Step 3: Scan Devices. Run a full system scan with reputable antivirus software to remove any malware or keyloggers.

Step 4: Financial Freeze. Contact your bank instantly to block cards and freeze accounts if financial data was exposed.

Step 5: Alert Contacts. Inform friends and family that your account was hacked so they don't fall for scams sent from your profile.

Step 6: Official Report. File a complaint on the National Cyber Crime portal (cybercrime.gov.in).

